

US 114051 · SO 1 · NQF LEVEL 5 · 4 CREDITS

Knowledge of Technical Practitioners Meetings



What meetings are for, the types organisations hold, leadership styles, decision-making processes, resolutions and the conventions that keep meetings fair

TIME	SESSION	MODULE	QUALITY ASSURANCE
90-minute lessons · Self & Group	Friday, 4 Sep 2026 · 09h00 – 14h00	Module 1 · Personal Development	QCTO / MICT SETA

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 1 & ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

What you must be able to demonstrate

Demonstrate knowledge of different types of technical practitioners meetings. You will be assessed against these criteria:



Meeting types & uses

Contract meetings, technical review meetings and project review meetings.



Leadership styles

Democratic, autocratic and facilitative meeting procedures.



Decision-making processes

Voting, consensus, criteria-based rating, ranking, paired comparisons.



Meeting conventions

Moving, seconding, amending and voting procedures.



The note taker

Why the note taker requires a technical background.



Why it matters

Meetings are where technical teams decide, plan and stay accountable.

What do we use meetings for?

- Meetings are very important for the work of any organisation — good meetings support collective decision-making, planning and follow-up, accountability and democracy.
- Used correctly, meetings help an organisation to be efficient. Used badly, they stop serving their purpose: too many long meetings that discuss the same thing over and over without moving forward.
- Meetings can become places where conflict is played out — and some people see attending meetings as working for the organisation, instead of a tool for getting work done.
- Aim for democratic, constructive participation and involvement from every member.
- The principal activities of a technical committee are the development and maintenance of its standards, technical reports and data files, in accordance with the purpose of the organisation.

The purpose of a meeting

- Most people do not like attending meetings — especially when they are not sure what the purpose is, or when the meeting goes on too long and achieves too little.
- Meetings must not be too frequent or held just for the sake of it — there must be a need for a meeting.
- Decide on the different types of meetings needed: some meetings discuss policy, others discuss organisation (practical work).
- Wherever possible, members must know what type of meeting they are going to and what it is for — the PURPOSE of the meeting.
- Sometimes an organisation calls a special or extraordinary meeting — planning should take account of the meeting type.

The meetings most organisations hold



General members meeting

The most common — monthly or every two weeks. Members are informed of developments, involved in decisions, and the executive reports on work done. This is where decisions are made.



Special meetings

Called to discuss specific issues — e.g. preparing for a conference or planning the year. Not run like general meetings: they focus only on the issue they were called for.



Executive meetings

Meet more regularly, with a business-like focus: plan implementation, monitor work, deal with problems, watch income and expenditure, and plan the next general meeting.



Annual General Meeting

Laid down in the constitution. The executive accounts for the year's activities and finances, and new leaders are elected with a mandate for the next year.

The AGM needs two detailed reports

THE SECRETARY'S REPORT

- The plans of the organisation for the year
- The actual activities that took place
- The achievements of the year
- The problems experienced

THE TREASURER'S REPORT

- All income — subscriptions, grants, donations, fundraising
- All expenditure for the year
- The balance, and where that balance is held
- Put the main headings on news-prints and explain it in less financial language

Three technical meetings you must know

For technical practitioners, three key meeting types are most relevant:



Contract meetings

Discuss, review and manage contractual obligations and deliverables related to technical projects or services.



Technical review meetings

Evaluate technical solutions, designs and implementations, and resolve technical issues and problems.



Project review meetings

Assess project progress, timelines, resource allocation and project deliverables.

Which meeting, when?

Meeting	Typical use	Example
Contract meeting	Negotiate or review a contract, SLA or deliverable with a client or supplier	Quarterly SLA review with the support vendor
Technical review	Evaluate a design, system or implementation against requirements and standards	Design review before a network upgrade
Project review	Track progress, risks, resources and milestones on a running project	Month-end review of the LAN rollout project

Who decides — the chair, the group, or both?

Various styles are used to ensure the outcome of the meeting is achieved — different outcomes require different commitment and involvement from participants:

Democratic

Held with appointed or nominated delegates from departments, organisations or areas. Delegates are given the information and all members have a voice in decision-making.

Autocratic

Hosted and led by a chairperson who runs the entire meeting and gives most of the input. Attendees give input only when instructed.

Facilitative

A group effort — the leader sets a trend of ensuring all members actively participate in the meeting to achieve the outcome or goal.

Matching the style to the meeting

Style	Who decides	Best when
Democratic	The members, by discussion and vote	Decisions need buy-in from every department or area represented
Autocratic	The chairperson	Time is critical, or one accountable owner must direct the outcome
Facilitative	The group, guided by a neutral facilitator	Ideas and problem-solving matter more than a formal ruling

Five ways meetings reach a decision

Voting

Each participant votes; the option with the most votes wins — simple majority (50% + 1) or supermajority (two-thirds or 75%).

Consensus

Discussion and compromise until all participants agree or can at least accept the decision.

Criteria-based rating

Rate each option against predetermined criteria; scores identify the best option.

Ranking

Rank options best to worst; scores per position are totalled across participants.

Paired comparisons

Compare options two at a time; the option preferred most often is selected.

Match the process

Pick the process that fits the decision's importance, urgency and need for buy-in.

Voting in practice — and why consensus first

- Show of hands: the chairperson calls for hands when opinions differ; votes are counted and the majority decides whether the proposal stands or falls away.
- Secret ballot: each person writes their support or objection on paper; votes are counted and the majority decides.
- A proposal is usually put forward by one person, seconded by another, and then voted on — if the majority accept it, it becomes binding on the organisation.
- It is usually better to reach consensus than to vote: consensus means compromises from everyone, but most people feel part of the decision.
- Sometimes a vote is necessary — for example in elections, or when the meeting cannot reach a decision through consensus.

Resolutions — formal decisions with three parts

- Resolutions are formal proposals put to the meeting to agree or disagree with; if passed they become policy of the organisation. Each needs a proposer and a seconder.
- NOTING — list the main issues of concern: “The AGM, meeting on (date), notes the rapid increase in crime in this area and its devastating effects...”
- BELIEVING — list the points that show your understanding of the issue and its causes.
- THEREFORE RESOLVES — list exactly what the organisation has decided to do or what its policy is on the issue.
- Amendments must be accepted by everyone present; if not, a vote is held and the chairperson records those for, against and abstaining. If the majority support the amendment, the original section falls away.
- The chairperson and members must study the constitution so they know and understand all these procedures.

Order, fairness and effective decisions



Moving

Formally propose a motion for the meeting to consider.



Seconding

A second member supports the motion — unseconded motions fall away.



Amending

Modify the motion before the vote; amendments are voted on first.



Voting procedures

Show of hands, ballot or poll — counted and recorded by the chair.



The note taker needs a technical background — minutes must capture the terminology, decisions and reasons accurately.

Procedural points every member should know

Members use these points to help the chairperson keep the meeting efficient — they should not be over-used just for the sake of it:



Point of Order

Raised when meeting procedure is not being stuck to — e.g. a speaker is totally off the point — to return the meeting to correct order.



Point of Information

A member asks to speak out of turn, to request or give more information on the matter being discussed.



Out of Order

The chairperson rules a member out of order for not sticking to procedure, being rude, interjecting or misbehaving.



Protection

A speaker who is being harassed while speaking can ask for the protection of the chairperson.



Quorum

The minimum number of members (set in the constitution) who must be present before the meeting can take decisions — without it, decisions can be forced to be re-discussed.



Use them well

These rules exist to make meetings more efficient and effective — not as weapons.

Your work for Specific Outcome 1



Questioning session

“Types of meetings, leadership styles and decision processes” — typed answers, AI-marked.



Quizzes 1 & 2

Meeting types & leadership styles · decision-making & conventions. 80%+ is competent.



Gate quizzes

Answer each lesson's gate quiz as you work through lessons 1–5 on the Lesson tab.



Know the meeting before you run the meeting.

General, special, executive and annual general meetings » contract, technical review and project review meetings » democratic, autocratic and facilitative styles » five decision processes » resolutions, conventions and procedural points — the knowledge every chairperson stands on.